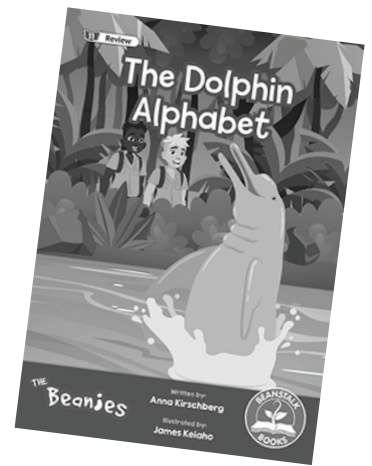




The Dolphin Alphabet

By Anna Kirschberg

Illustrated by James Keiaho



Book Summary

This book looks at a simple and interesting story about Ted and Mat, who are seeking the mysterious pink dolphin in the Amazon River. The pink river dolphin is called the 'boto'. What do the boys learn about this dolphin species? The text will introduce the reader to new and more complex vowel sounds. Detailed and vibrant illustrations depict and help the text explain some basic story information about each page.

This book follows the Beanstalk Books (Letters & Sounds) Phase 5 progression and focuses on teaching new vowel sounds and alternative pronunciations.

Skills and Strategies

This book builds on decodable reading strategies for high/low readers. The book has been written using a strictly controlled vocabulary. Text uses only **decodable regular words** (according to the week by week progression of Letters & Sounds) along with **'tricky words'** or **'Common Exception Words'** (CEWs). Common Exception Words are frequently used words that are not decodable at this phase.

Phase 5 - Vowel Sounds

ay	ou	ie	ea	oy	ir	ue	aw
wh	ph	ew	oe	au	ey	a-e	e-e
i-e	o-e	u-e					

Tricky Words:

the, is, to, of, do, has, I, are, they, he, you, sure, have, said, some, also, come, one, about, where, called, their, talk, also, asking, find, asks, know, boto, learn, other, read

This book also supports other key reading strategies:

- Recognising the relationship between words and illustrations;
- Pointing one-to-one at each word to ensure an appropriate match;
- Vocabulary and word study.

This book also supports key comprehension strategies:

- Predicting the meanings of new or unfamiliar words from the context of the story;
- Recognising the relationship between letters and their sounds;
- Summarising the main ideas of the story;
- Responding to simple questions about the story's content and word meanings.

Introducing the Text

Open up the discussion about the front cover illustration and make connections with the children's prior knowledge. Prompt discussions by using the vocabulary in the book.

What can you see on the front cover image?

Describe the characters in the illustration.

What do you predict will happen in this story, based on the title?

Read the title and the name of the author to the group. Read aloud the featured common exception words from each phase, from the front inner cover.

Reading the Text

Pages 2 and 3 – Explain where to begin reading, and ask the student to point to each word as you read aloud together. The main characters in this story are Ted and Mat, who are seeking the mysterious pink dolphin in the Amazon River.

The pink river dolphin is called the 'boto'.

What do the boys learn about this dolphin species?

Pages 4 and 5 – On the next pages, what else do the boys learn about the boto?

Pages 6 and 7 – Next, the boys observe the dolphin as it blows bubbles at them in the river.

Page 8 – On the last page of the story, what does Ted say to Mat about the dolphin?

Children can now read the book independently. At the end of the story, go over the text and illustrations again and discuss what is happening on each page.

Revisiting the Text

As a group, refer back to the table in the front inner cover and identify the words in the story that use the new vowel sounds being taught in Phase 5. Identify as many new vowel sounds as you can in words in the text. For example: 'ph' in 'dolphin' and 'alphabet'.

Revisit the common exception words in the text. Notice the use of any different types of punctuation. Can you find the pages that have speech marks in the text?

Following Up

Use the BLM for this story, the students can learn more about the different types of vowel sounds being used in the text of the story.